

Be the Judge — No. 3

Watch first. Then judge. Then build.

Name: _____ Date: _____

Same scores as always — every answer is **correct**; you judge the *explanations*.

1 = Just the answer — no reason.

2 = Gives a reason — but only tries one way.

3 = A real explanation — it works no matter what you try.

Part 1 — Watch the judge at work

Four friends share 14 cookies — the same number each, none left over. Can they?

Answer A

“No.”

Score it (circle one):

1

2

3

***Judge:** True — but no reason. Not an explanation yet.*

Answer B

“No. I tried 3 cookies each — that uses 12, and 2 are left over. So it doesn’t work.”

Score it (circle one):

1

2

3

***Judge:** A real reason — but only one try. Maybe a different share works? Showing one try fail doesn’t show every try must fail.*

Answer C

“No. Four equal shares means the total is a number you say when counting by 4s. Counting by 4s goes 12, then 16 — it skips 14. So no way of sharing can ever work.”

Score it (circle one):

1

2

3

***Judge:** The winner. It never tries a single share — the counting-by-4s list skips 14, and that rules out every try at once. Nothing could talk you out of it.*

Part 2 — Your turn — just like that one

Circle a score for each. The same score can go to more than one answer.

Three kids share 16 crayons — the same number each, none left over. Can they?

Answer A

“No. I tried it out: I dealt 5 crayons to each kid, one at a time, and that used up 15 of them, so there was 1 crayon left over with no fair place to go. So it doesn’t work.”

Score it (circle one): **1** **2** **3**

Answer B

“No, they can’t.”

Score it (circle one): **1** **2** **3**

Answer C

“No. Three equal shares means the total is on the counting-by-3s list. That list goes 15, then 18 — it skips 16. So no share can ever come out equal.”

Score it (circle one): **1** **2** **3**

Part 3 — Judge once more — bigger numbers

Seven kids share 30 candies — the same number each, none left over. Can they?

Answer A

“No. I gave each kid 4 candies — that’s 28, with 2 left over. So it doesn’t work.”

Score it (circle one): **1** **2** **3**

Answer B

“No, and I’m completely sure about it. I thought about this one really carefully, for a long time, and there is just no possible way it could ever happen, trust me.”

Score it (circle one): **1** **2** **3**

Answer C

“No. Seven equal shares means the total is on the counting-by-7s list, and that list goes 28, then 35 — it skips 30.”

Score it (circle one): **1** **2** **3**

Answer D

“No.”

Score it (circle one): **1** **2** **3**

Part 4 — Watch one get built

Here is a whole explanation, built line by line. Every line is **one complete sentence**, and the last line always starts with **So** and answers the question.

Can 4 kids share 13 marbles equally — the same number each, none left over?

The explanation — one sentence per line:

1. Equal shares for 4 kids means the total is on the counting-by-4s list.
2. Counting by 4s goes 12, then 16 — it skips 13.
3. So 13 marbles can never be shared equally by 4 kids.

Part 5 — Your turn — write the last line

Same kind of question, same kind of explanation. Lines 1 and 2 are done. Write line 3 — one sentence, starting with **So**.

Can 6 kids share 20 stickers equally — the same number each, none left over?

The explanation — one sentence per line:

1. Equal shares for 6 kids means the total is on the counting-by-6s list.
2. Counting by 6s goes 18, then 24 — it skips 20.
- 3.

Part 6 — One more — two lines, with a head start

Line 1 is done. Lines 2 and 3 are started for you — finish each one. One sentence per line.

Can 5 kids share 22 apples equally — the same number each, none left over?

The explanation — one sentence per line:

1. Equal shares for 5 kids means the total is on the counting-by-5s list.
2. *Counting by 5s goes ...* _____
3. *So ...* _____

Answer Key — for parents

What changed since sheet No. 2. That one stumbled because it skipped the model: it asked them to judge a new kind of reason (skip-counting instead of odd/even) and to build sentences — both without ever seeing one done. This sheet fixes the step size: watch the judge work one (Part 1), do a near-twin (Part 2), then vary (Part 3). Same for building: a finished explanation to read (Part 4), a twin needing only its last line (Part 5), then two lines with head-start words (Part 6).

The scores. Part 1 is worked on the sheet ($A \rightarrow 1$, $B \rightarrow 2$, $C \rightarrow 3$).

Part 2: $A \rightarrow 2$ (deals one share and stops — longest answer, but length isn't reasoning), $B \rightarrow 1$, $C \rightarrow 3$ (the counting-by-3s list skips 16 — rules out every share).

Part 3: $A \rightarrow 2$, $B \rightarrow 1$ (very sure, zero reason), $C \rightarrow 3$, $D \rightarrow 1$.

The build parts — what counts. Their own words, one sentence, a period at the end.

Part 5, line 3: anything like “So 20 stickers can never be shared equally by 6 kids.”

Part 6, line 2: “Counting by 5s goes 20, then 25 — it skips 22.” **Line 3:** “So 22 apples can't be shared equally by 5 kids.”

If a line comes out as a run-on, have them read it aloud and find where the breath goes — that's where the period goes.

How to run it. Part 1 and Part 4 are for reading *together, out loud* — they are the lesson; don't skip past them to the scoring. The rest they do solo. Saying a build line aloud before writing it is fair play.